

Narrative Advertisement

A Script on Youth Disillusionment & the MACES Study-Abroad Campaign

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Introduction

This project was a narrative advertisement script developed around the experiences of three young Bangladeshi women dealing with different forms of frustration and disillusionment with the current state of the country. The advertisement follows them through five connected scenes, beginning with the everyday experience of rising prices at a local market, moving into political disengagement on social media and eventually showing how political unrest affects even their personal lives.

The narrative gradually builds toward the introduction of MACES, an educational consultancy offering study-abroad opportunities. Rather than presenting the brand through a conventional promotional format, the advertisement connects the service with the characters' growing desire to explore opportunities outside Bangladesh.

This project was particularly valuable to me because it allowed me to combine social observation with commercial storytelling. It required me to think not only as a writer but also as someone creating a narrative for a specific client and audience.

Concept and Message

The central idea of the advertisement was to portray the growing frustration and uncertainty experienced by some young people in Bangladesh. Each scene was designed around a specific social issue.

The first scene focuses on price inflation and economic pressure, showing how rising costs affect ordinary decisions in everyday life. The second reflects political apathy, particularly through the way young people may disengage from political discussions and trends on social media. The third shows how political unrest can enter people's personal lives, even affecting something as ordinary as a date between friends.

These individual situations gradually create a larger picture of youth disillusionment. Rather than having a character directly explain that young people are losing faith in the country's future, I tried to communicate the idea through their everyday reactions and conversations.

The MACES flyer then becomes the turning point of the narrative. At first, the characters ignore it, but after experiencing several frustrating situations, they reconsider it. This allowed the study-abroad opportunity to emerge naturally from the story rather than appearing as an unrelated advertisement.

Learning to Write for a Commercial Narrative

One of the most important things I learned from this project was that commercial writing is different from journalistic writing. As a journalism student, I am accustomed to focusing on information, accuracy and presenting a subject clearly. Advertising requires another layer of thinking: the story must attract attention, create an emotional connection and eventually lead the audience toward a particular action.

The challenge was to make the advertisement entertaining without losing the social reality behind it. I did not want the scenes to feel like a political lecture followed by a sudden advertisement for an educational consultancy.

Instead, I structured the narrative around the characters' experiences. The audience first gets to know the frustrations of the three friends, and the brand enters only after those frustrations have accumulated. This helped make the final call to action feel connected to the story.

Scene-by-Scene Storytelling

Writing the advertisement scene by scene taught me how important pacing and progression are in a short commercial.

Each scene contributes something different to the emotional development of the characters. The market scene establishes economic frustration. The social-media scene introduces political disengagement. The disrupted date adds a more personal dimension to the problem. As these experiences accumulate, the characters become increasingly frustrated.

The convergence of the three characters and the MACES flyer then provides the narrative resolution.

I particularly enjoyed working with comedic moments alongside serious social observations. Humour can make a difficult subject more approachable, while the more dramatic moments remind the audience of the seriousness underneath the comedy. Learning to balance these two tones was one of the most useful parts of the project.

Balancing Social Commentary and the Client's Goal

The biggest challenge was balancing the project's social commentary with MACES's commercial objective.

The advertisement needed to ultimately encourage potential customers to book an appointment for study-abroad opportunities. However, if the brand appeared too aggressively throughout the story, it could make the social commentary feel artificial.

I therefore tried to make the product a solution that emerges from the characters' circumstances. The flyer is initially ignored, which makes the eventual decision to pick it up more meaningful. By the end, the characters actively visit the MACES website and book an appointment.

A strong narrative can create the emotional context first and allow the brand's call to action to become part of the story.

Character and Emotional Development

Another important learning experience was understanding the value of character-driven storytelling in advertising.

Instead of presenting statistics about inflation, political instability or youth migration, the script shows three young women experiencing frustration in ordinary situations. This makes the issues more relatable and gives the audience characters they can emotionally connect with.

The characters also allowed the advertisement to avoid becoming completely pessimistic. Their frustration eventually turns into a decision. This transition from disillusionment to possibility is important because the advertisement ultimately needs to leave the audience with a sense of direction.

Challenges

One of the major challenges was ensuring that the social commentary did not overpower the commercial purpose. Since the advertisement dealt with politically sensitive and socially relevant issues, there was always a possibility that the audience could focus more on the political message than the brand.

Another challenge was making the transition to MACES feel natural. A study-abroad consultancy could easily feel disconnected from scenes about market prices or political unrest. I addressed this by using the flyer as a recurring visual element and allowing the characters' frustration to build toward their decision.

If I were developing the advertisement further, I would refine the dialogue and visual transitions even more. I would also experiment with different endings to determine which call to action feels most natural and memorable for the target audience.

Personal Learning and Outcomes

This project expanded my understanding of scriptwriting and commercial storytelling. I learned how to take real social observations and turn them into a structured narrative that has a beginning, progression, emotional climax and resolution.

I also developed a better understanding of how advertising can communicate social realities without becoming purely informational. The project showed me that commercial media can contain social commentary while still fulfilling a client's promotional objective.

Most importantly, I learned how important it is to understand the client's goal before developing the story. The purpose was not simply to tell a story about frustrated Bangladeshi youth; the story ultimately had to motivate the audience to consider an alternative educational future and engage with MACES.

This required me to think about audience psychology, emotional progression and brand placement at the same time.

Conclusion

Overall, this project was a valuable experience because it allowed me to move beyond traditional journalistic writing and explore commercial scriptwriting and visual storytelling. The advertisement demonstrated how everyday social experiences can be transformed into an emotionally engaging narrative while still serving a specific client's objective.

Through the five scenes, I learned how to build frustration gradually, use humour and drama to maintain audience attention, and introduce a brand as a natural part of the story rather than forcing it into the narrative.

The project also made me reflect on the relationship between youth disillusionment and aspirations for opportunities abroad. By connecting these observations with MACES's study-abroad service, I was able to create a narrative that was commercially purposeful while remaining grounded in recognizable social experiences.

Ultimately, the project strengthened my ability to write for different media contexts. It taught me that effective commercial storytelling is not simply about selling a product; it is about creating a story that makes the audience understand why the product matters to the characters—and potentially to them as well.